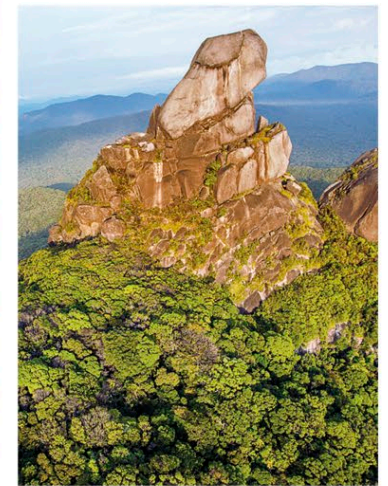


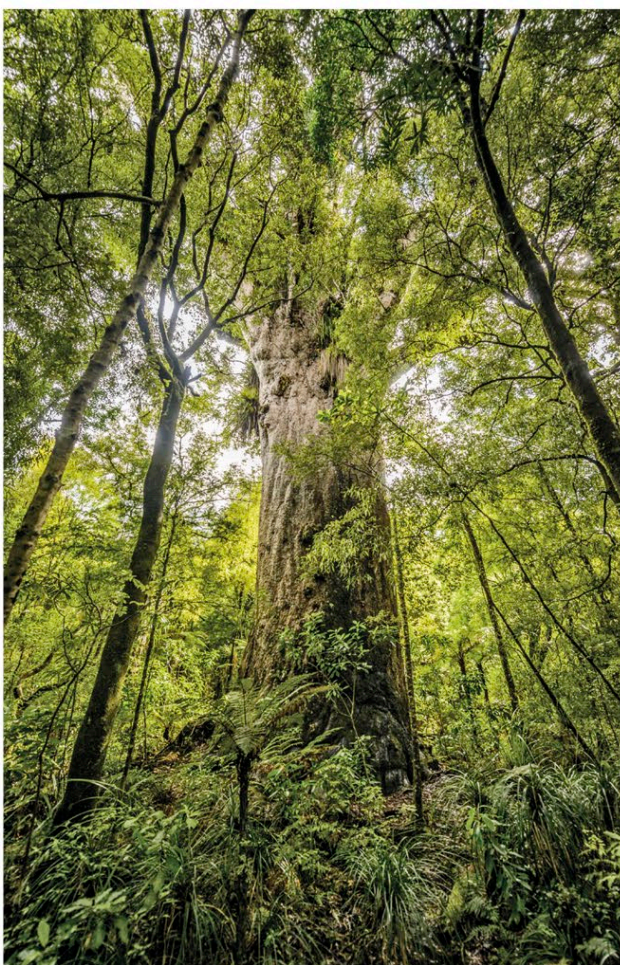


△ STANDING GUARD

The granite summit of Mount Pieter Botte, or Ngalba-bulal, keeps watch over the Daintree National Park's rare black kauri pines.

◁ PREHISTORIC LANDSCAPE

Because of its isolated location and climate, the Daintree has remained largely unchanged since its origin. Today, it is home to 12 of the world's 19 families of primitive flowering plants.



Waipoua Forest

An ancient native New Zealand forest, home to the world's largest stand of kauri trees



The subtropical Waipoua Forest lies on the west coast of the Northland Region of New Zealand's North Island. Declared a sanctuary in 1952, Waipoua contains Earth's largest collection of kauri trees—giant, cone-bearing, hardwood conifers that are among the oldest trees in the world and are also some of its most endangered. While ancestors of the kauri were growing during the Jurassic Period, Waipoua's most ancient kauri, called Te Matua Ngahere, or Father of the Forest, is merely 2,000 years old. However, with a girth of 52 ft (16 m) and a height of 121 ft (37 m), it has the largest diameter of any living kauri—and it is still growing.

◁ IMPOSING HEIGHT

Kauris can reach heights of up to 165 ft (50 m), making them dominant emergent trees that rise above other conifers, such as toatoas and monoas, in the surrounding forest.

▽ SEED-BEARERS

A single kauri produces both cylindrical male and round female cones. Not until a tree is 25–30 years old will its female cones release fertile winged seeds.

